Email: jclark58@illinois.edu

Jackson Clark

Experience

Microsoft Research — Redmond, WA (Onsite, Full-Time)
Research Intern, Agentic Innovation — Summer 2026
- Making agents more reliable.

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign — Urbana, IL (Onsite, Full-Time)
Graduate Research Assistant, xLab — Fall 2024 – Present
- Building the AI for production stack.
- Leading **SREGym**, a live benchmark for AI SRE agents with high-fidelity failure scenarios, supported by a **Laude Institute Slingshot Grant** (2025).
- Co-authored **STRATUS** (NeurIPS 2025) and **ITBench** (ICML 2025, Oral, Top 1%); lead maintainer of **AIOpsLab** (800+ GitHub stars).

NASA Marshall Space Flight Center — Huntsville, AL (Onsite, Full-Time)
Software Engineer Intern, Huntsville Operations Support Center (HOSC) — Summer 2023
- Developed a forward error correction library in C++ based on CCSDS standards (BCH, LDPC, and convolutional codes) for NASA's GPDM mission.
- Contributed to software automation tools supporting flight controllers.

NASA Ames Research Center — Mountain View, CA (Remote, Full-Time)
Research Intern, Intelligent Systems Division — Summer 2023
- Led reinforcement learning research for multi-agent pathfinding (MAPF) in urban air traffic management, leveraging Python, PyTorch, TensorFlow, and Docker on a supercomputing cluster.

NASA Goddard Space Flight Center — Greenbelt, MD (Remote, Part-Time)
Software Engineer and Data Science Intern, HEASARC — Fall 2022 – Spring 2023
- **Spring Project:** Trained ML models (scikit-learn, TensorFlow) to classify neutron star spectra using NICER payload data.
- **Fall Project:** Redesigned SkyView, a React + Flask data catalog system for querying astrophysics datasets by sky position.

NASA Marshall Space Flight Center — Huntsville, AL (Onsite, Full-Time)
Software Engineer Intern, Payload Operations Integration Center — Summer 2022
- Designed an automation tool for ISS flight controllers to streamline timeline change processes.

Education

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign — Urbana, IL
Ph.D. Computer Science — Fall, 2024–Present

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign — Urbana, IL
B.S. in Information Sciences + Data Science, GPA: 3.82/4.00 — 2020–Spring, 2024

Invited Talks

- **SREGym** — Spring 2026
  Microsoft Research, System Intelligence Seminar.
- **STRATUS** — March 17, 2026
  University of Toronto, ECE1770. Hosted by Yifang Tian and Hans-Arno Jacobsen.

Teaching

- **Instructor** at Discovery Partner's Institute — Summer 2024, Summer 2025, Summer 2026
  Designed and taught a 2 week Data Science Intensive program to educate Chicago Public School teachers to create their own data science lessons for their classrooms.
- **Course Assistant** at UIUC — Spring 2023 - Spring 2024
  Data Science Discovery (CS 107)

Publications

Clark, J., Y. Su, S. M. R. Pial, L. Gniedziejko, and T. Xu (2026). "SREGym: A Live Training Ground for AI SRE Agents with High-Fidelity Failure Drills". In: *Conference on AI Systems (CAIS), Demo Track*.

Clark*, J., Y. Su*, S. M. R. Pial, Y. Tian, L. Gniedziejko, H.-A. Jacobsen, Y. Chen, and T. Xu (May 2026). "SREGym: A Live Benchmark for AI SRE Agents with High-Fidelity Failure Scenarios". In: *arXiv:2605.07161*. Supported by a Laude Institute Slingshot Grant. arXiv: 2605.07161.

Chen*, Y., J. Pan*, J. Clark*, Y. Su*, N. Zheutlin, B. Bhavya, R. Arora, Y. Deng, S. Jha, and T. Xu (2025). "STRATUS: A Multi-agent System for Autonomous Reliability Engineering of Modern Clouds". In: *Advances in Neural Information Processing Systems (NeurIPS)*. Accepted. arXiv: 2506.02009 `[cs.DC]`.

Jha*, S., R. Arora*, Y. Watanabe, T. Yanagawa, Y. Chen, J. Clark, et al. (2025). "ITBench: Evaluating AI Agents across Diverse Real-World IT Automation Tasks". In: *Proceedings of the 42nd International Conference on Machine Learning (ICML)*. Oral Presentation (Top 1%). arXiv: 2502.05352 `[cs.AI]`.

Awards

- **Laude Institute Slingshot Grant** for **SREGym** 2025